Informatica

Business Asset Type Relationships

Data Governance and Catalog

Where data & AI come to LIFE

Abstract

This article provides a visual representation of the types and nature of relationships that are possible between assets in Data Governance and Catalog. The diagrams also depict the relationship between data from Reference 360 and assets in Data Governance and Catalog.

Introduction

Informatica Data Governance and Catalog has several business asset types that you can use to describe different aspects of your organization and govern the data items as necessary.

Data Governance and Catalog includes the following business asset types:

- **AI Model**
- **AI System**
- **Business Area**
- **Data Set**
- **Data Quality Rule Template**
- **Data Quality Rule Occurrence**
- **Geography**
- **Glossary Domain**
- **Glossary Subdomain**
- **Glossary Business Term**
- **Glossary Metric**
- **Legal Entity**
- **Policy**
- **Process**
- **Project**
- **Regulation**
- **System**

Business Assets

As a data consumer, Business Assets allow you to describe why you use the data, where you use the data, and how you use the data to make business decisions. Business Assets provide context to your data using relationships with other business assets and by using simpler representations of technical data.

When you document a new asset or add business metadata to your data, you create an asset in Data Governance and Catalog called a **business asset**. Use business assets to perform governance functions such as collaborating with stakeholders, viewing the audit history of data, and generating reports to comply with regulatory requirements. Business assets include glossary, policy, domain, and data set.

Technical Assets

Technical assets are representations of data elements, technical data sets, data containers, and catalog sources that Metadata Command Center extracts from a source system.

Technical assets in Data Governance and Catalog can be broadly categorized in the following manner:

- Data elements are the smallest units of data in a source system. Columns, files and fields are examples of data elements.
- Technical data sets are collections of data elements. For example, a table is a technical data set because it is a collection of columns.
- Data containers hold the data for an application. Examples of data containers are schema and database.
- Catalog sources are objects that represent the source system from which you extract metadata. You can create catalog sources in Metadata Command Center to extract metadata from source systems like Amazon S3 and Oracle.

Asset Relationships

A relationship between assets depicts how the assets relate to each another. In Data Governance and Catalog, you can use various types of relationships to connect business assets to each other and to relevant technical assets.

When you open an asset, the **Relationships** tab displays the relationships between the selected asset and other business and technical assets in Data Governance and Catalog. For example, you can see how a data set links to other assets such as a system, column, process, or policy.

Generally, you can create only one type of directional relationship between assets. Occasionally, Data Governance and Catalog allows you to create more than one type of directional relationship between assets.

Reference Data

You can associate data from Reference 360 with business terms, metrics, manual data elements, and data elements in Data Governance and Catalog. The reference data provides standardized values that you can use to enrich your assets in Data Governance and Catalog.

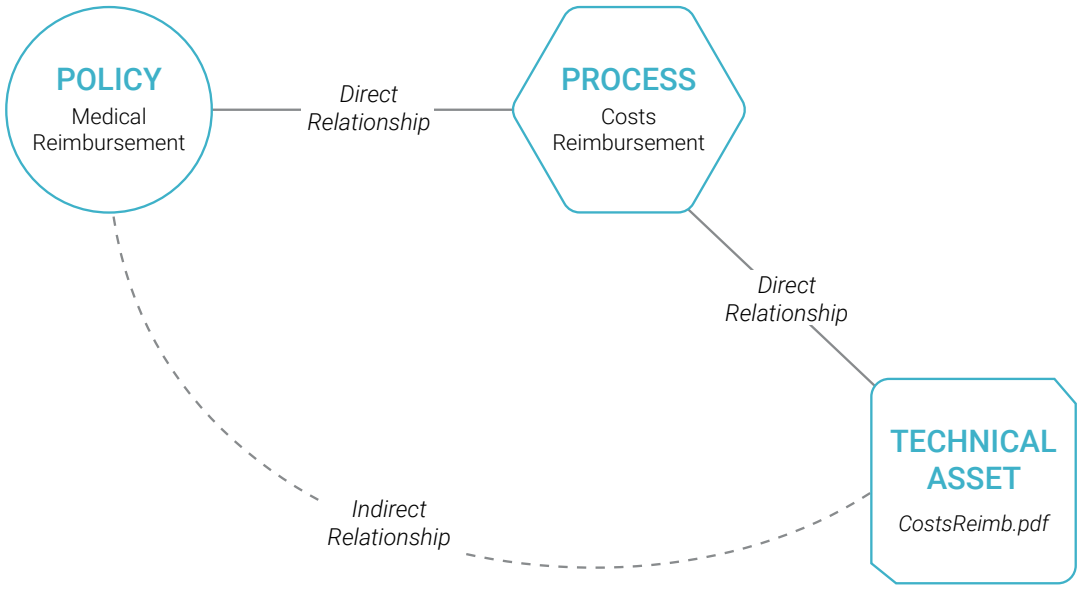
You can associate reference data with glossaries and data elements. Additionally, you can use the reference data in data classifications to enrich your technical assets.

Types of Relationships

Many assets in Data Governance and Catalog are interconnected. You can create the following types of directional relationships between assets:

- **Inbound direct.** When you create a relationship from a target asset to the source asset, you establish a direct relationship between the assets.
- **Inbound indirect.** When you create a relationship from a target asset to the source asset, if one of the assets is already connected to a third asset, you establish an indirect relationship between the third asset and the asset to which it wasn't previously connected.
- **Outbound direct.** When you create a relationship from the source asset to a target asset, you establish a direct relationship between the assets.
- **Outbound indirect.** When you create a relationship from the source asset to a target asset, if one of the assets is already connected to a third asset, you establish an indirect relationship between the third asset and the asset to which it wasn't previously connected.

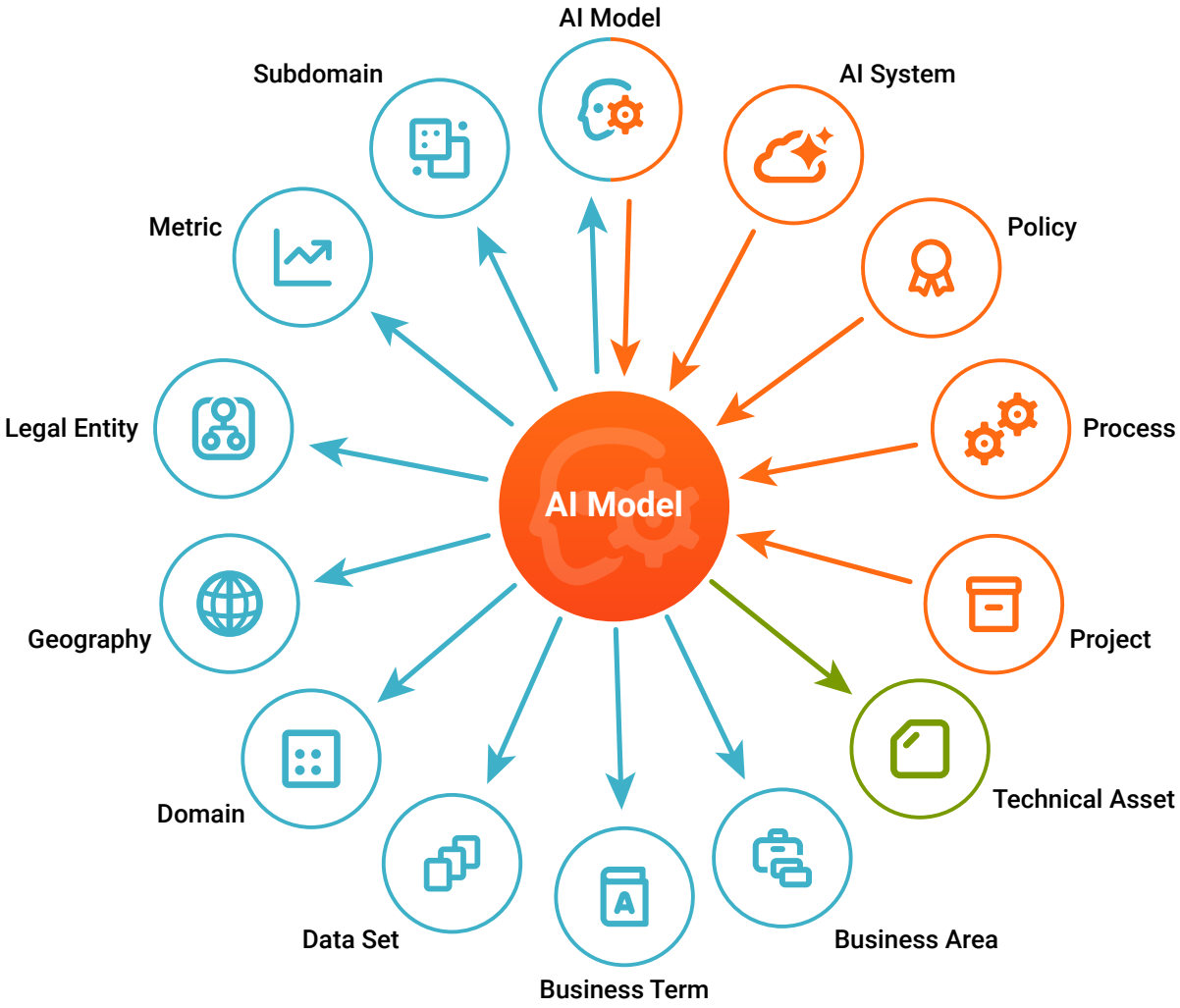
The following image shows an example of the direct and indirect relationships of a process asset:

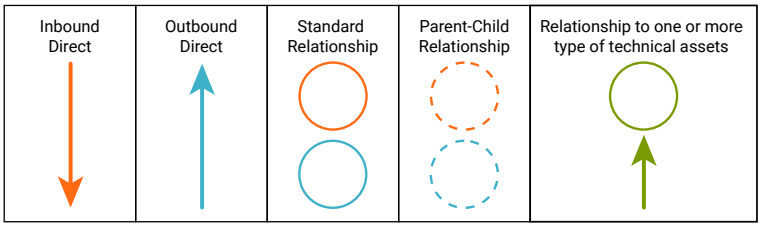


The *Costs Reimbursement* process asset is in a direct relationship with the *Medical Reimbursement* policy asset. The *CostsReimb.pdf* technical asset is connected to the *Medical Reimbursement* policy asset through the *Costs Reimbursement* process asset. This indicates that the *CostsReimb.pdf* technical asset is in an indirect relationship with the *Medical Reimbursement* policy asset.

AI Model

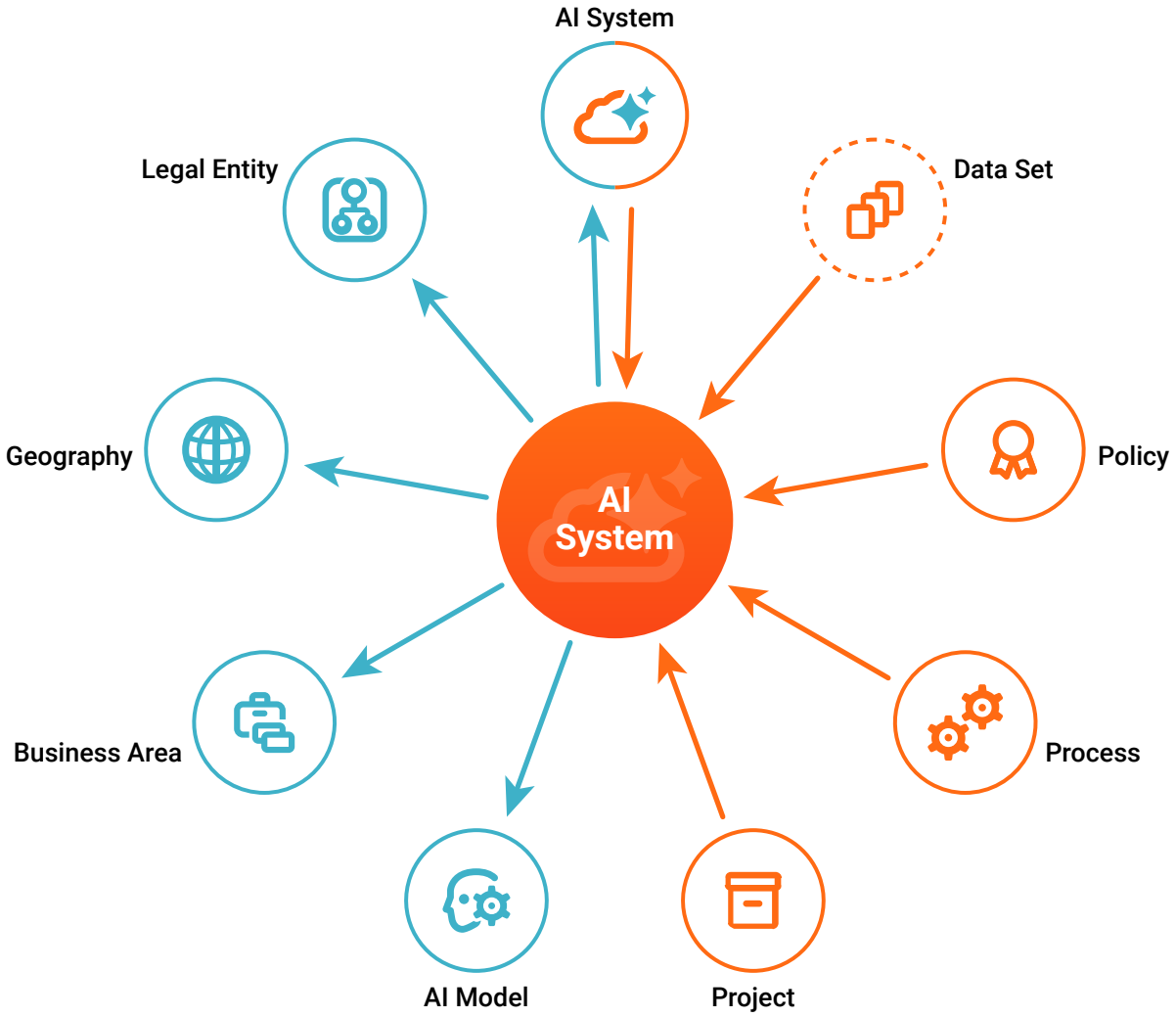
An AI model asset represents the essential parameters of an AI model. These parameters also include the environment where the model is run, the input parameters and the output data, and the business purpose and rules for the model. AI models provide insights for many activities so that you can make decisions faster and easier or provide prediction modeling.





AI System

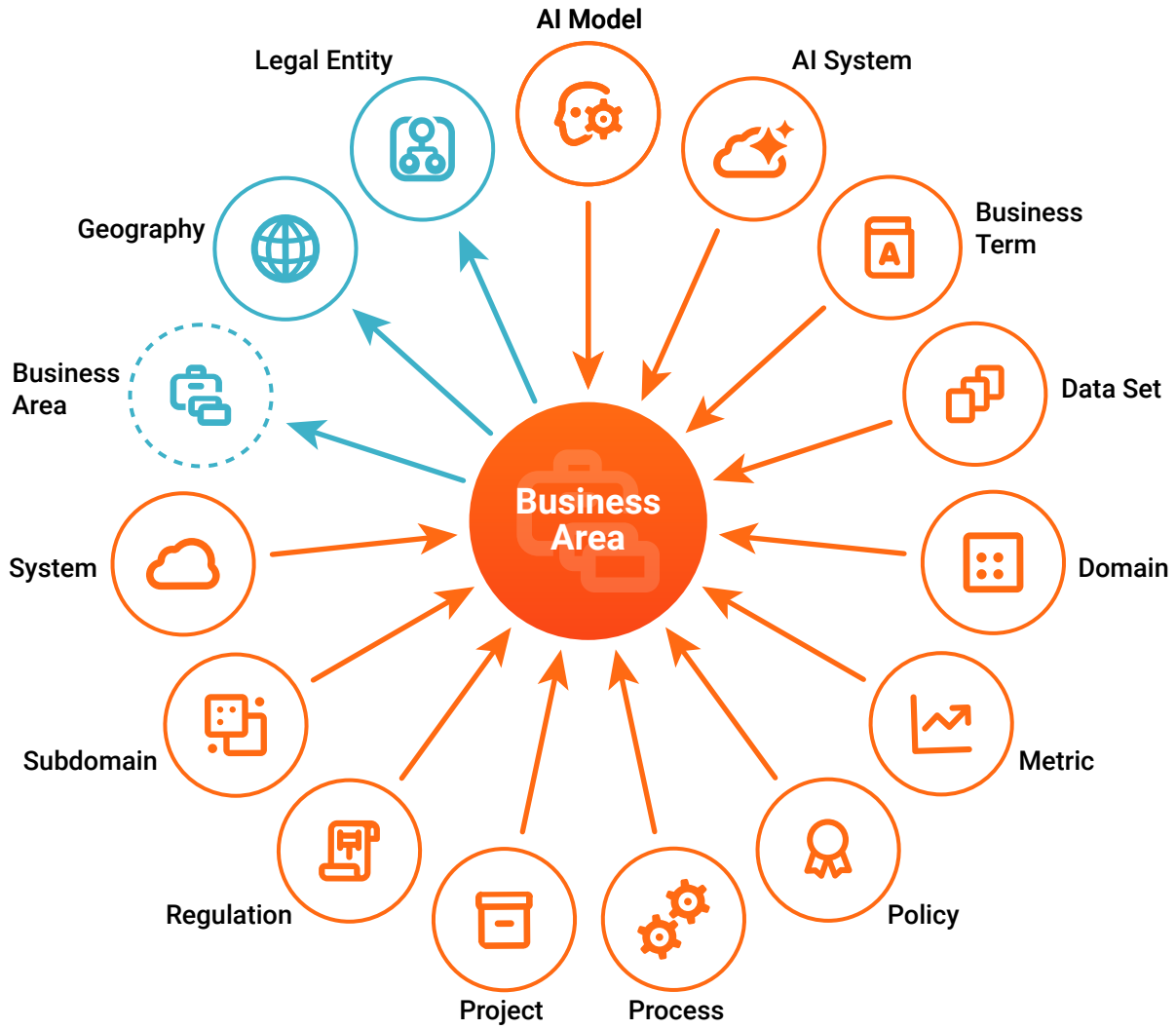
The AI System asset is a machine learning-based system that uses multiple AI models to perform a range of tasks, such as generating predictions, content, recommendations, decisions, and actions. The asset records information about the technologies, AI models, and data that is used to perform these tasks.

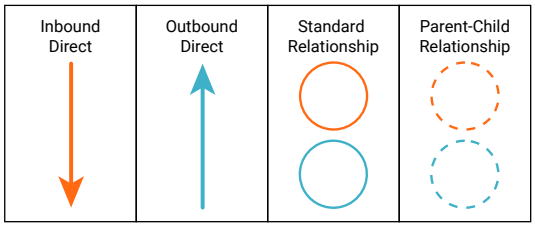


Inbound Direct	Outbound Direct	Standard Relationship	Parent-Child Relationship

Business Area

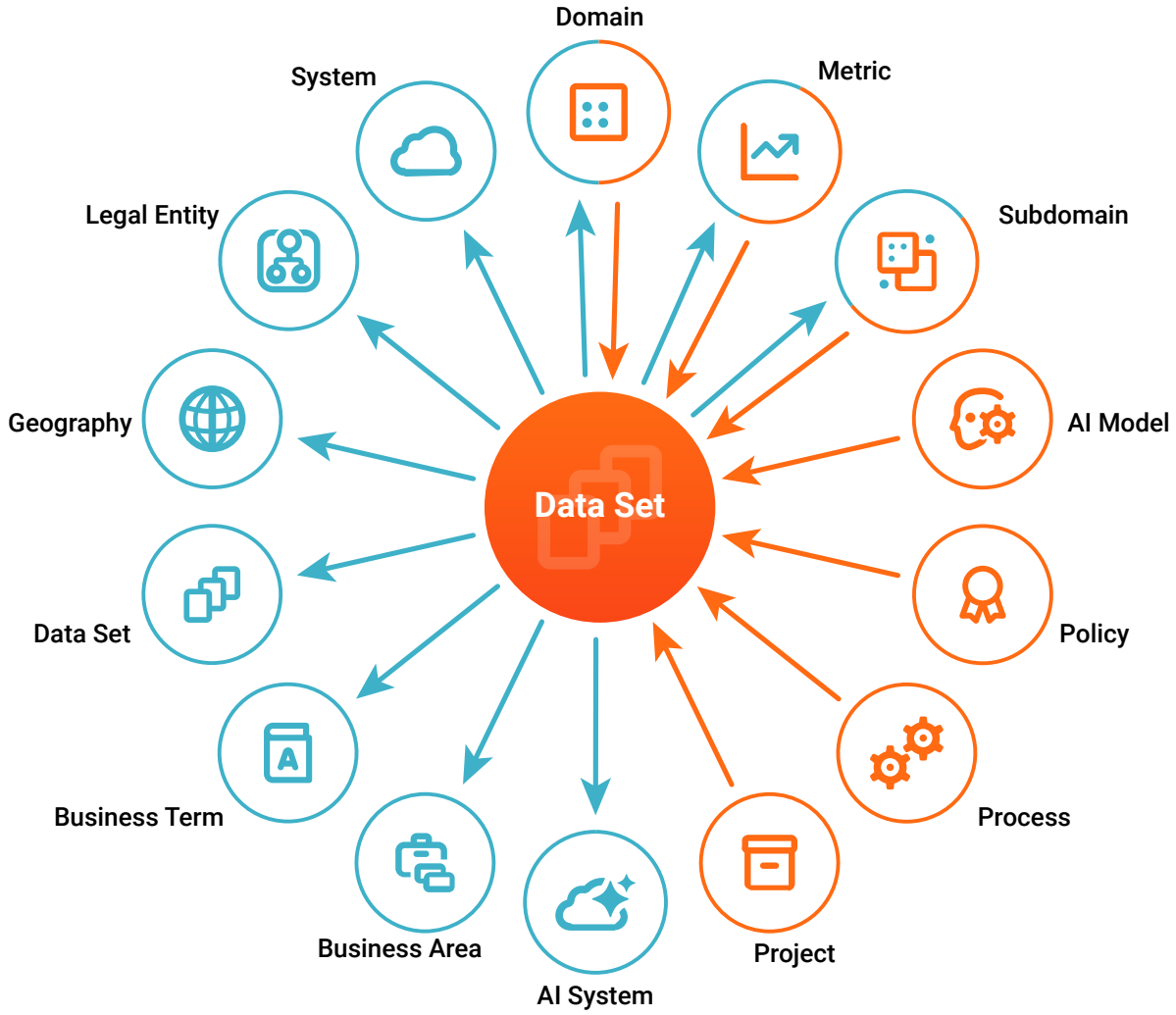
A Business Area asset represents a department or business function with certain assigned responsibilities in the wider organization.

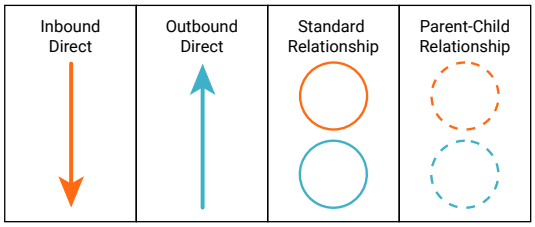




Data Set

A Data Set asset represents identifiable groupings of data for a particular purpose. Data Sets are business-friendly representations of technical assets such as tables, files, and more. A Data Set asset focuses less on the technical aspects of how the data is delivered and more on the information provided by the data set.

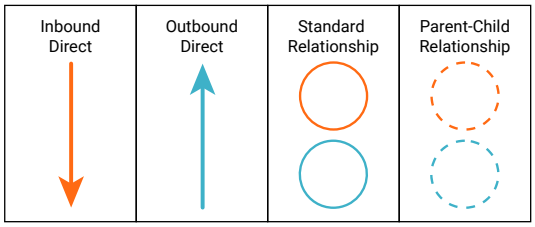




Data Quality Rule Template

A Data Quality Rule Template asset is the business representation of a data quality rule specification. You can use a data quality rule template to create a data quality rule. The actual data quality score of data elements are expressed as Data Quality Rule Occurrences in Data Governance and Catalog. As data quality rules set business expectations, they are often associated with glossary assets such as Business Terms and Metrics.

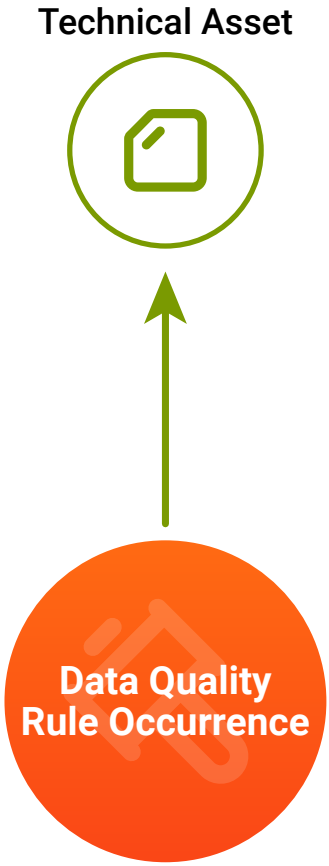


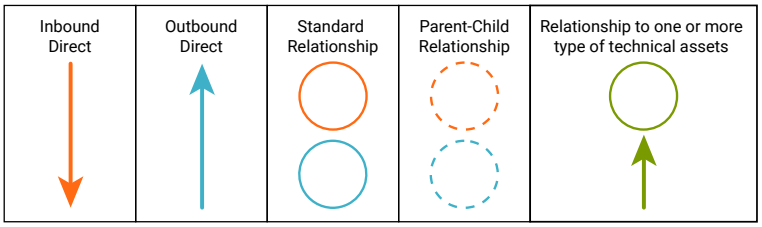


Data Governance and Catalog Asset Relationships

Data Quality Rule Occurrence

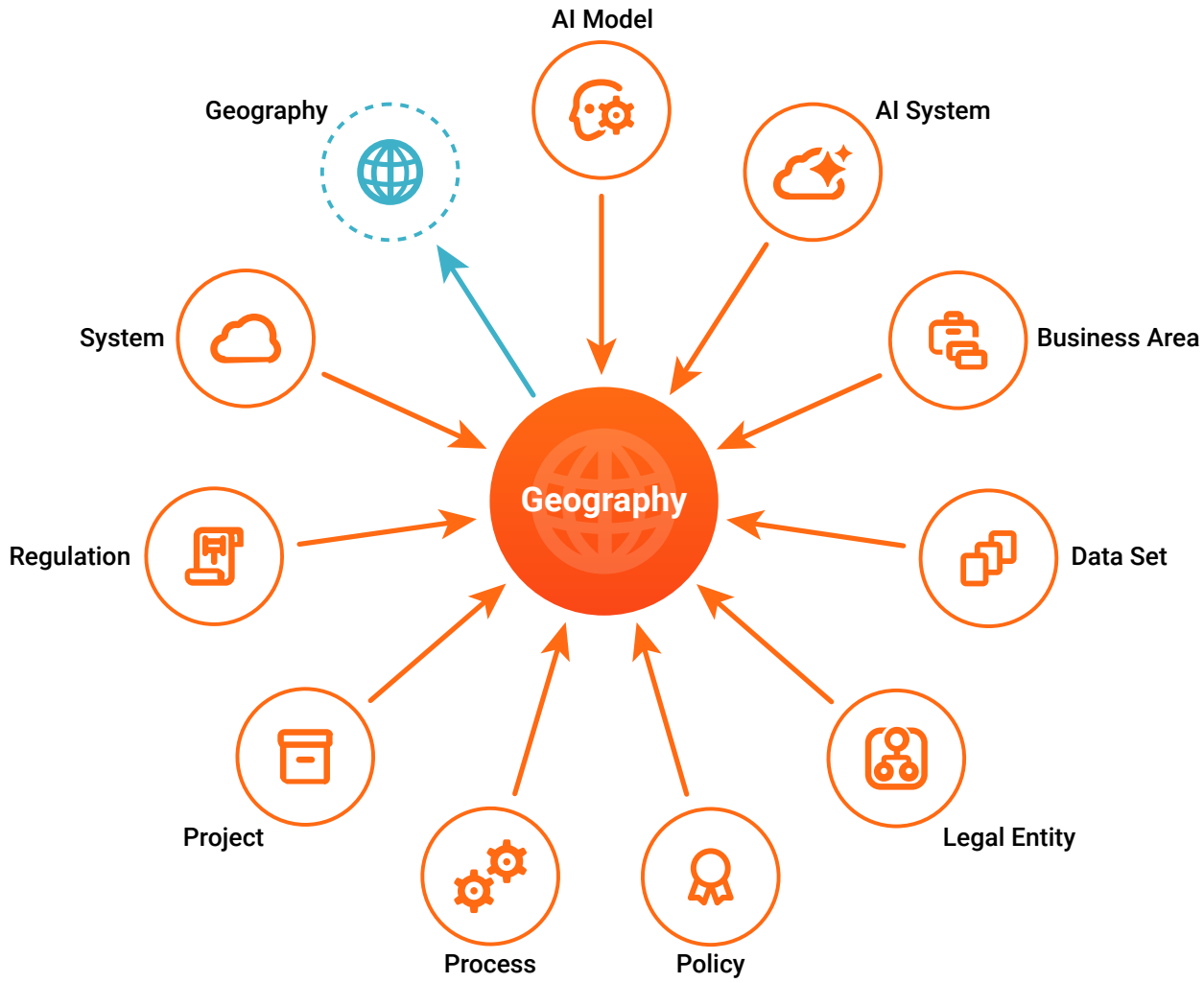
A data quality rule occurrence is the business representation of a data quality rule that is run on data elements. You can rate a Data Quality Rule Occurrence asset to indicate your assessment of the quality of the asset or add your comments to the asset to provide your inputs on the data present within the asset. This enables different users to collaborate on assets and make collective decisions on using the data.

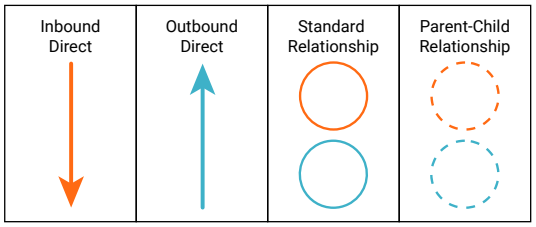




Geography

A Geography asset captures areas, regions, or countries relevant to where your organization operates. You can use a geography asset to show how different business assets are relevant to different locations.





Glossary

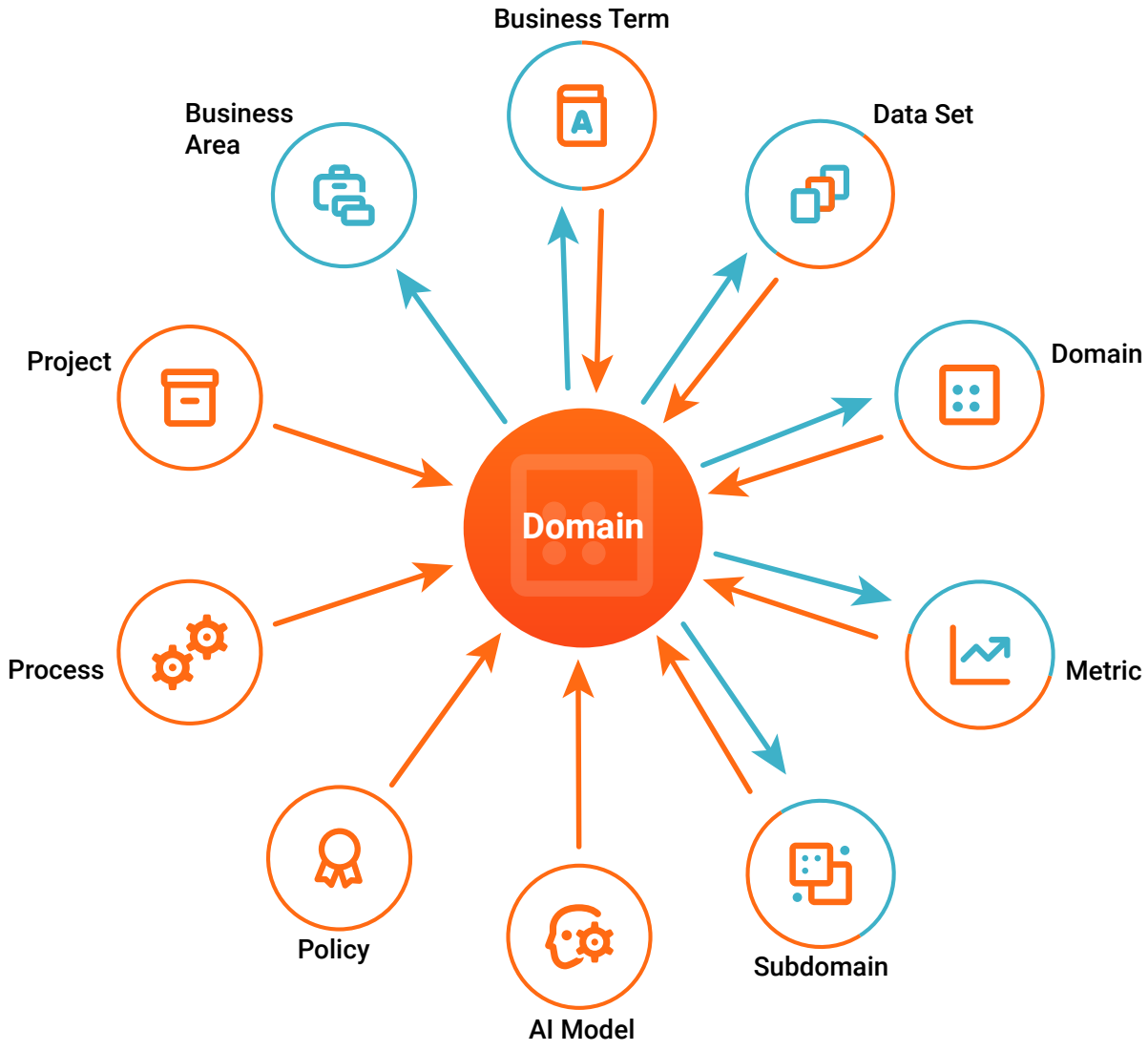
A glossary is a collection of business-friendly terms. Relationships made to and from a glossary asset contribute to better governance across your organization. Certain types of glossary assets can be linked to data sets and data elements to help clarify their purpose in your organization.

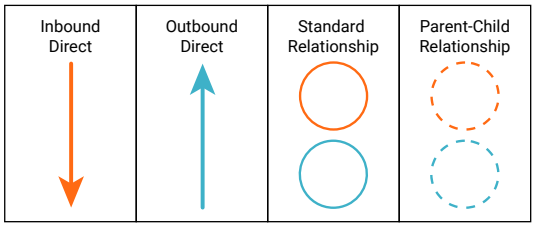
In Data Governance and Catalog, you can create the following types of glossary assets:

- **Glossary Domain**
- **Glossary Subdomain**
- **Glossary Business Term**
- **Glossary Metric**

Glossary Domain

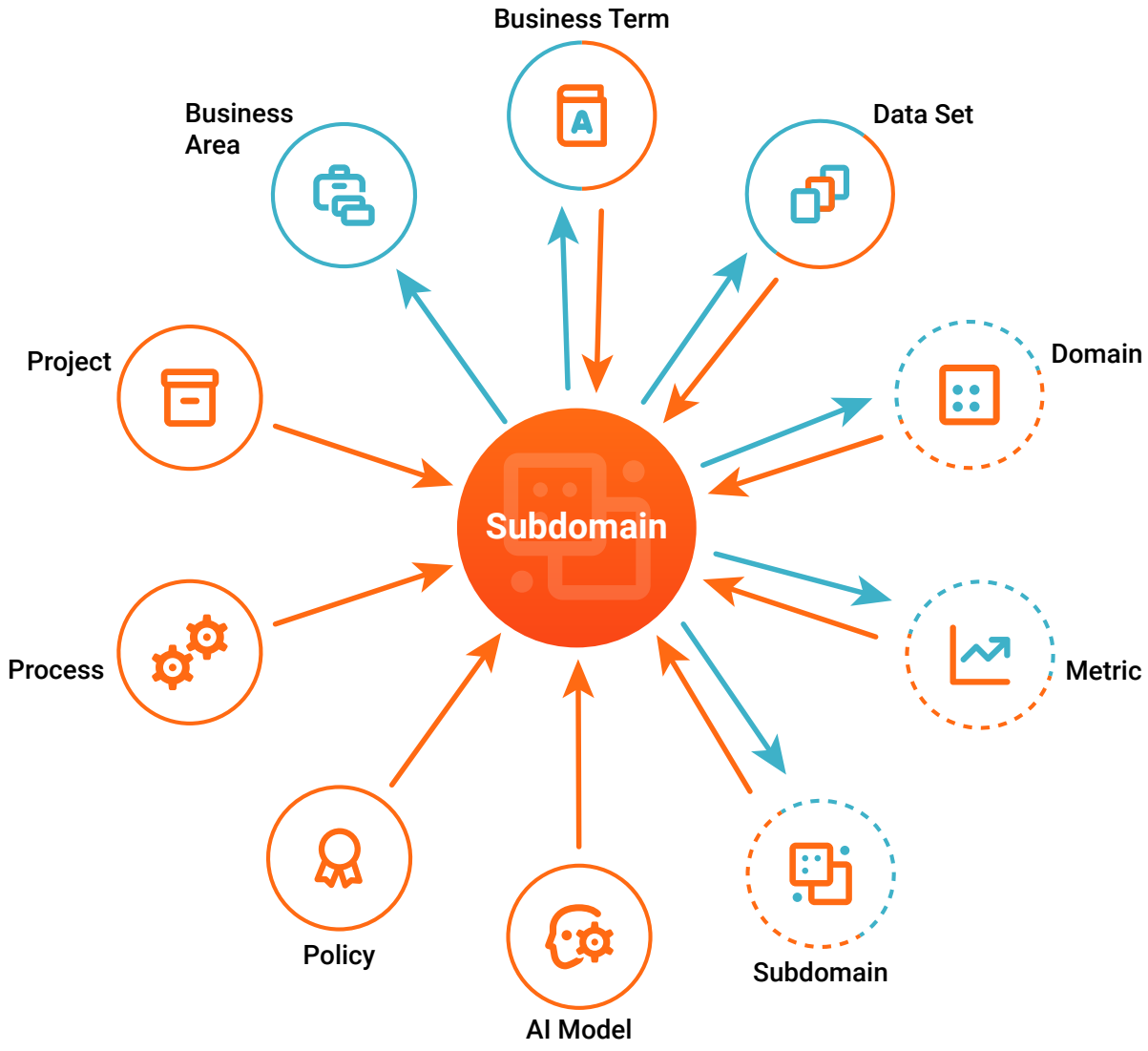
A glossary asset of the Domain type refers to a collection of business concepts and activities that can be grouped together for a specific function or requirement. A domain is a subject matter area under which many terms can be organized. You can use a glossary domain to assign semantic and business context to an actual business concept.

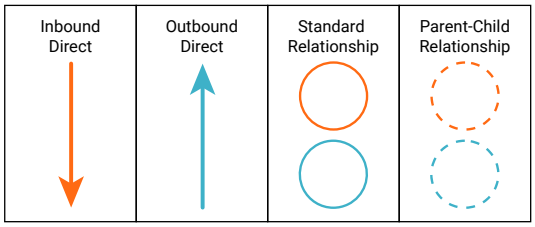




Glossary Subdomain

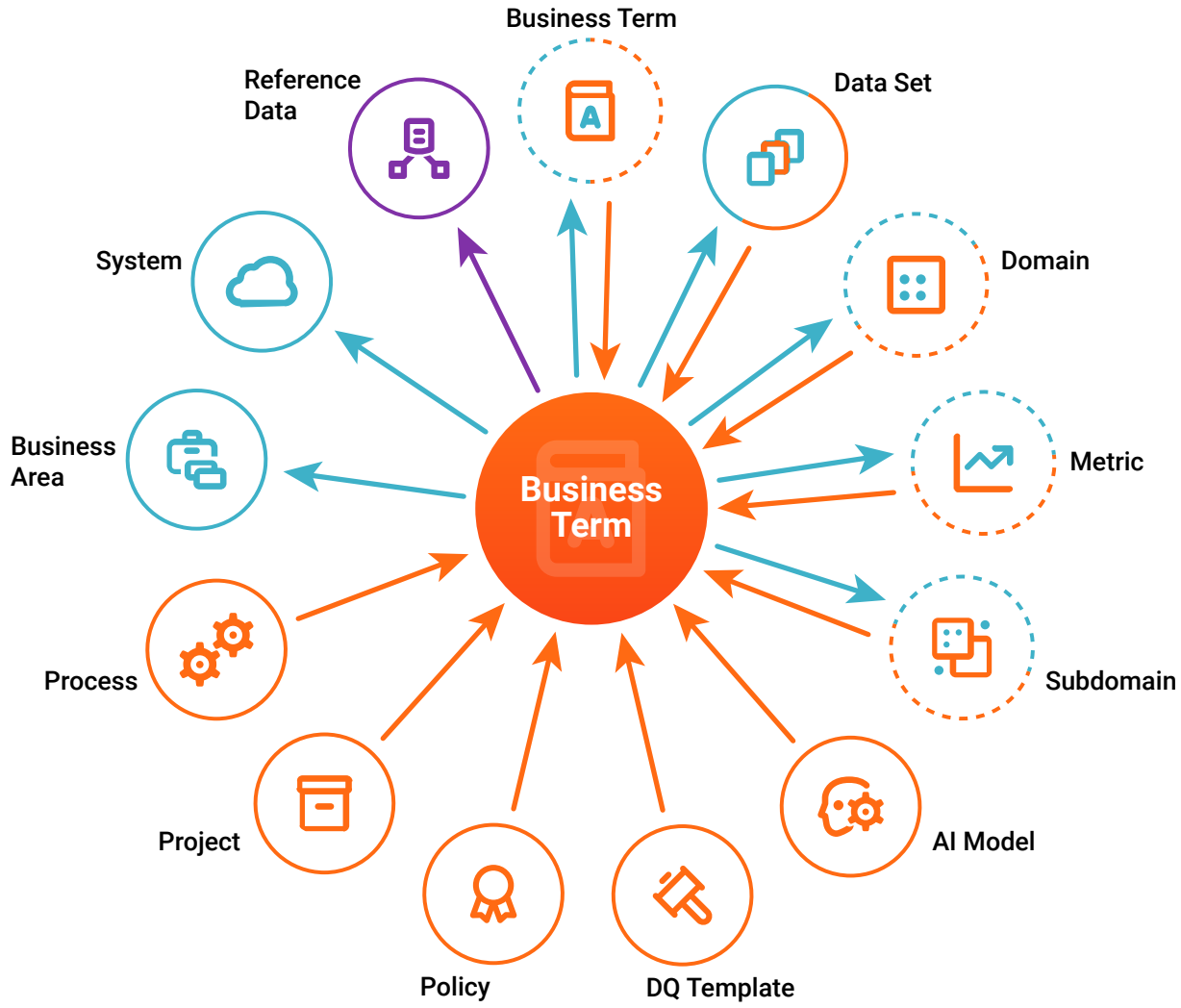
A glossary asset of the Subdomain type refers to a concept or activity that constitutes a specific business function or requirement. A domain is typically divided into subdomains to help organize business terms and metrics. You can use a glossary subdomain to assign semantic and business context to an actual business concept.

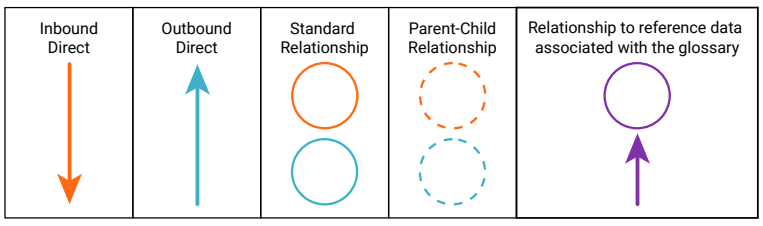




Glossary Business Term

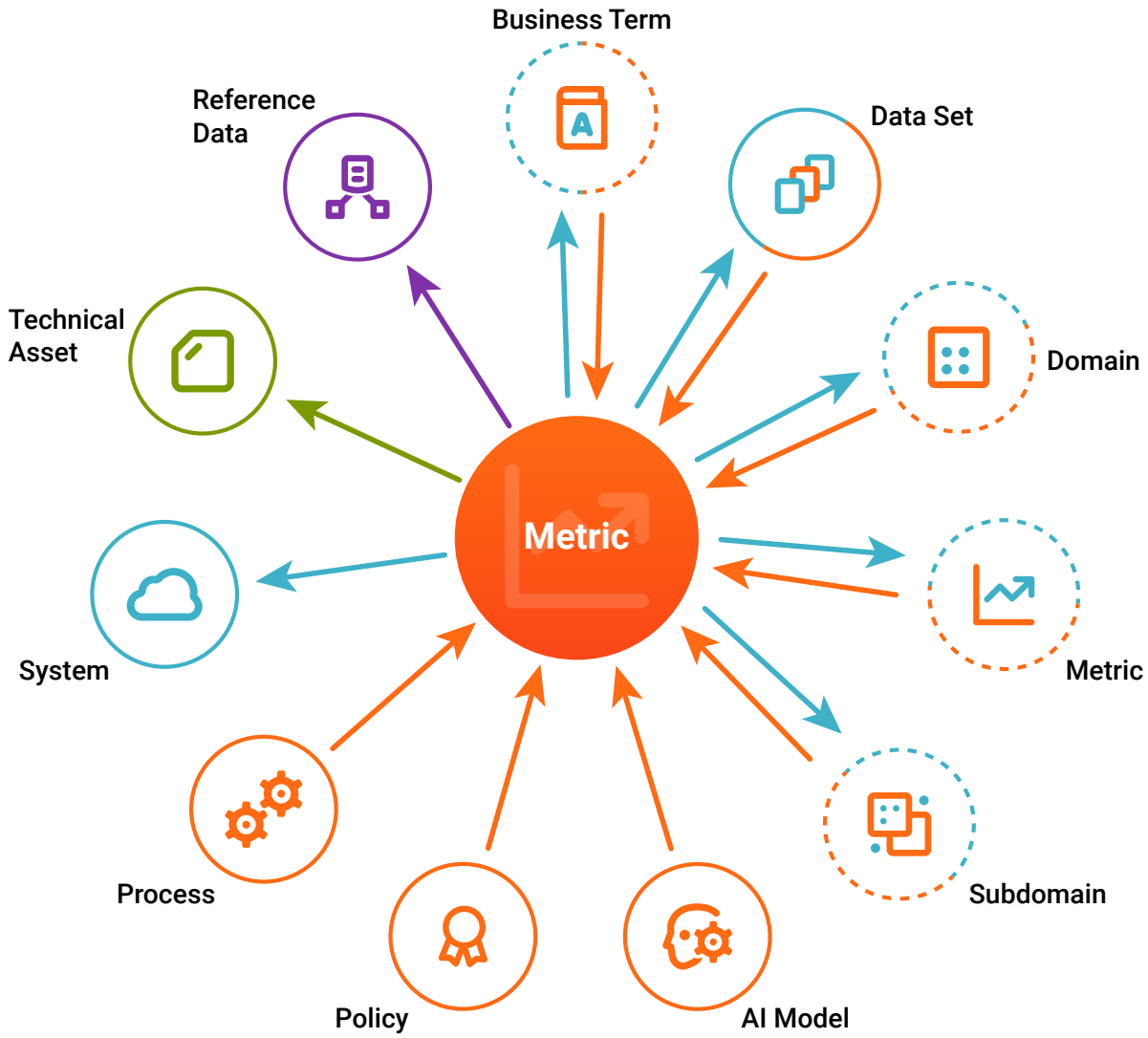
A glossary asset of the Business Term type can be used to capture a business definition that is used in your organization. Most business terms tend to be realized as data elements and can be used to indicate that different data elements represent the same concept, whatever the name they have in each table.

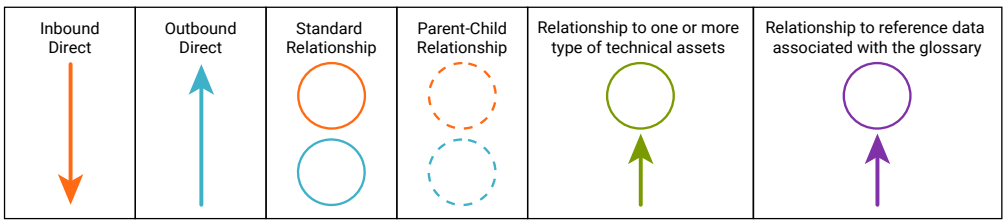




Glossary Metric

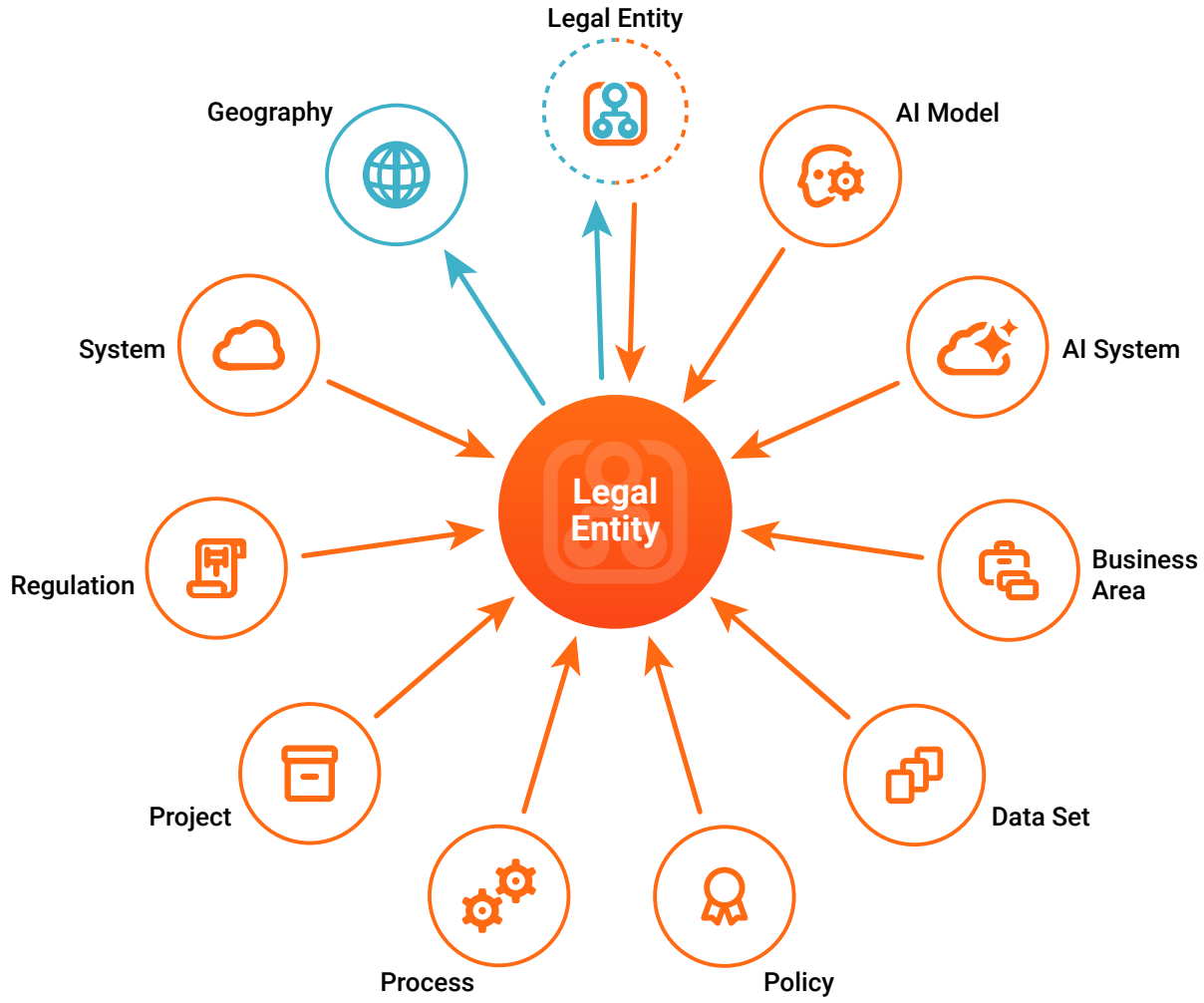
A glossary asset of the Metric type refers to the definition of the measurement of a business result. This measurement is typically a numerical indicator of business success. You can use a metric asset to assign semantic and business context to an actual business measurement.

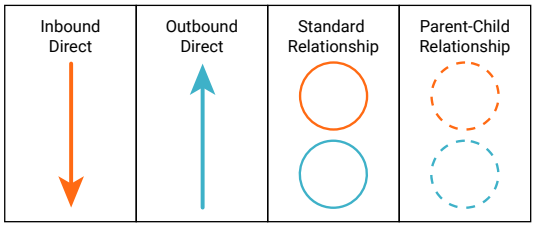




Legal Entity

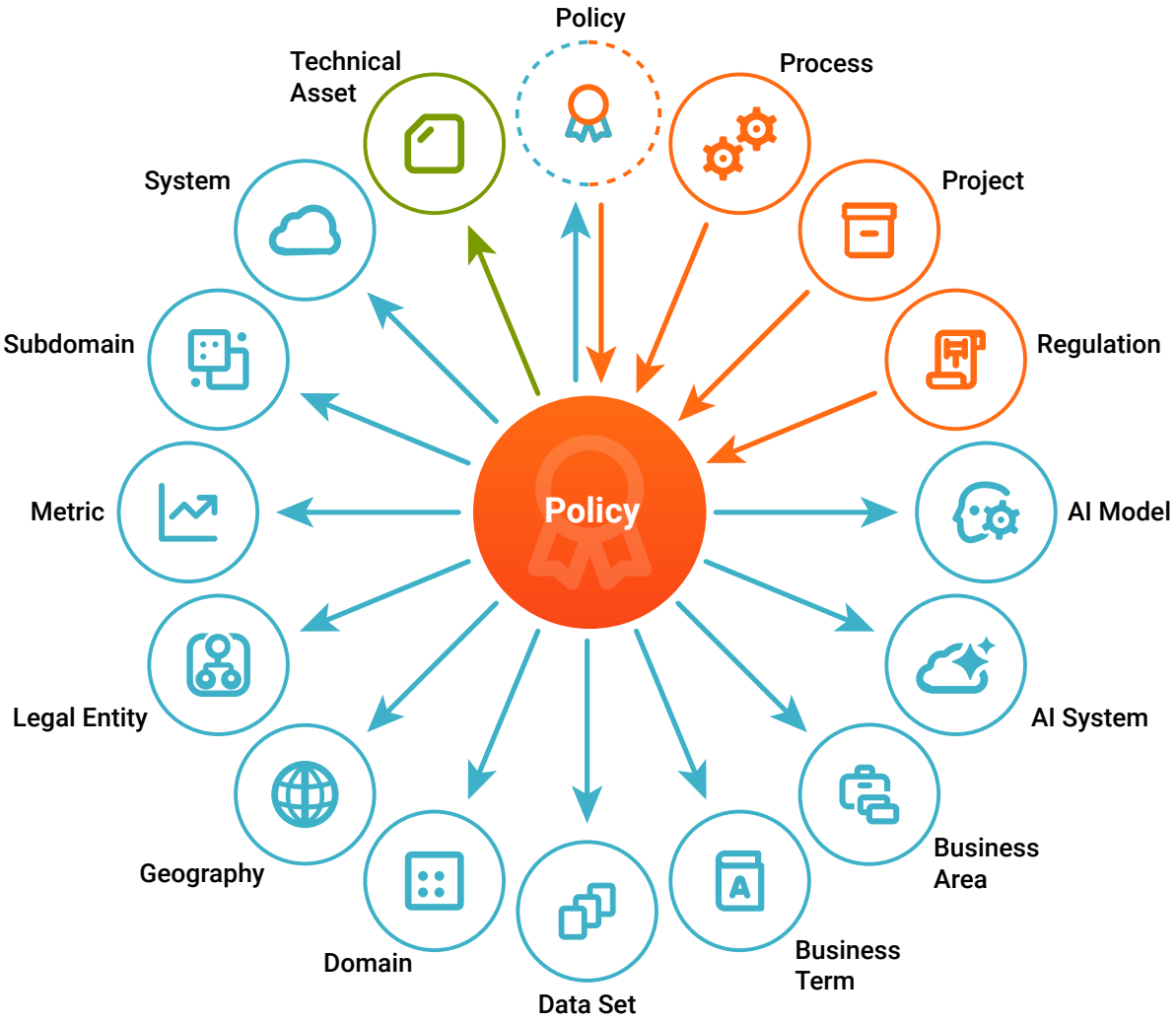
A Legal Entity asset captures corporate entities, whether these are part of the customer's own group of companies or trusted partners and vendors, that can be used to make relationships to other business assets to provide context.

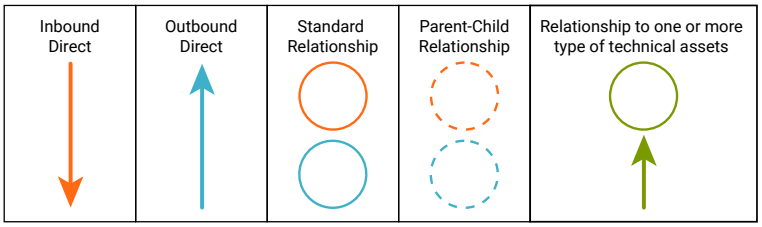




Policy

A Policy asset represents an internal collection of rules and guidance on how to conduct business and manage data. They may be inspired by company goals, external regulations, or commercials agreements.

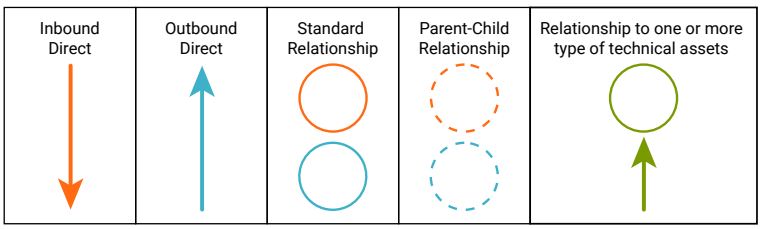




Process

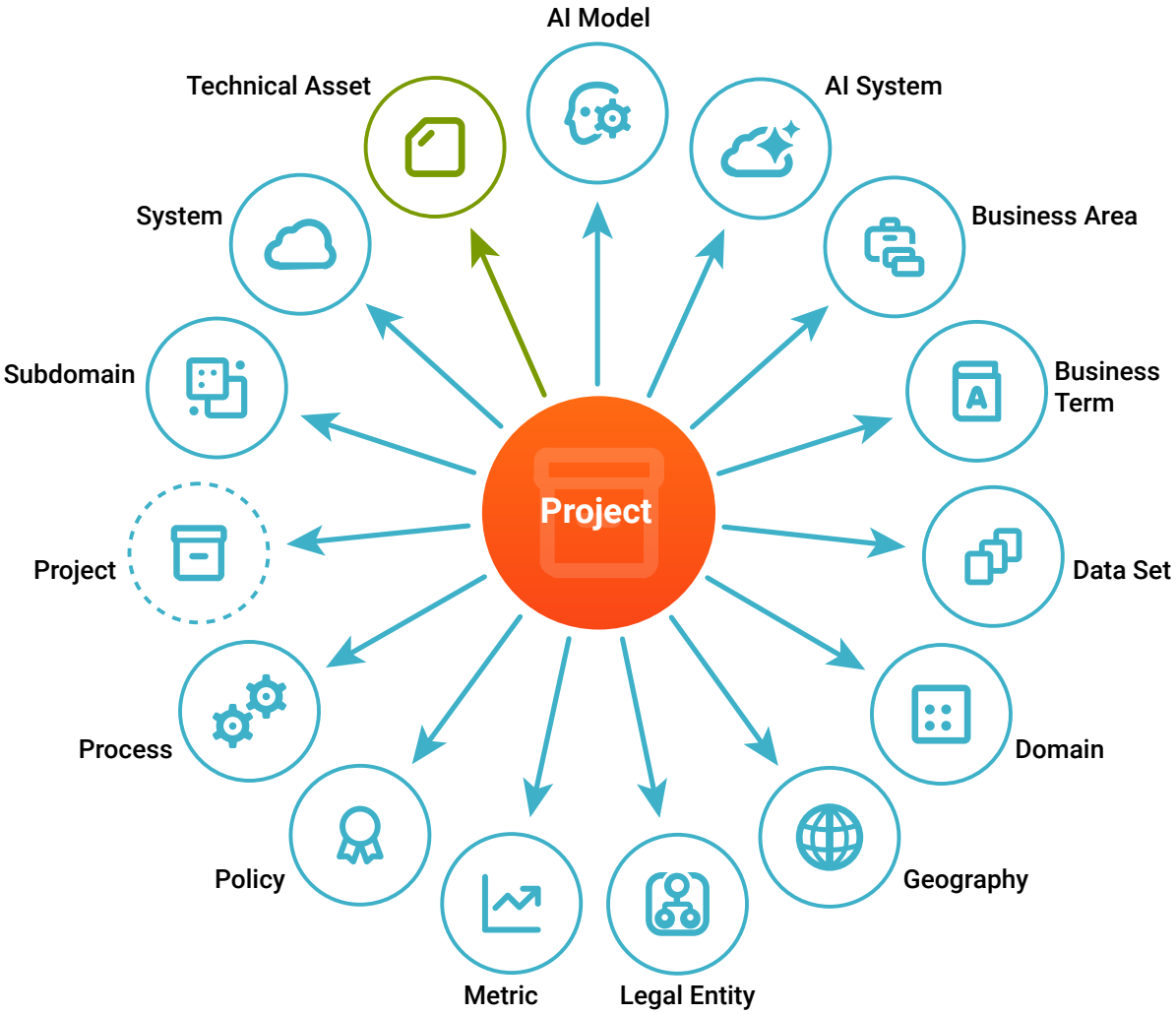
A Process asset allows you to document important business activities so that the activity can be contextualized through relationships. These activities allow business users to record the key reasons on why they consume data. Processes are typically structured as a parent process using the recognized name of the activity, with a series of child process steps that explain the key stages involved in executing that activity. Each individual process object can have its own set of relationships to explain key metadata associations.

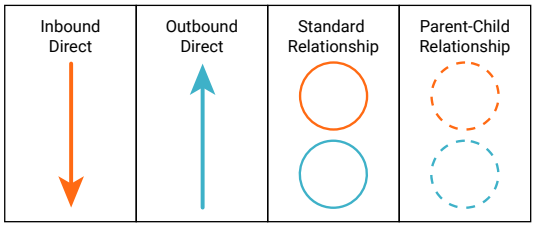




Project

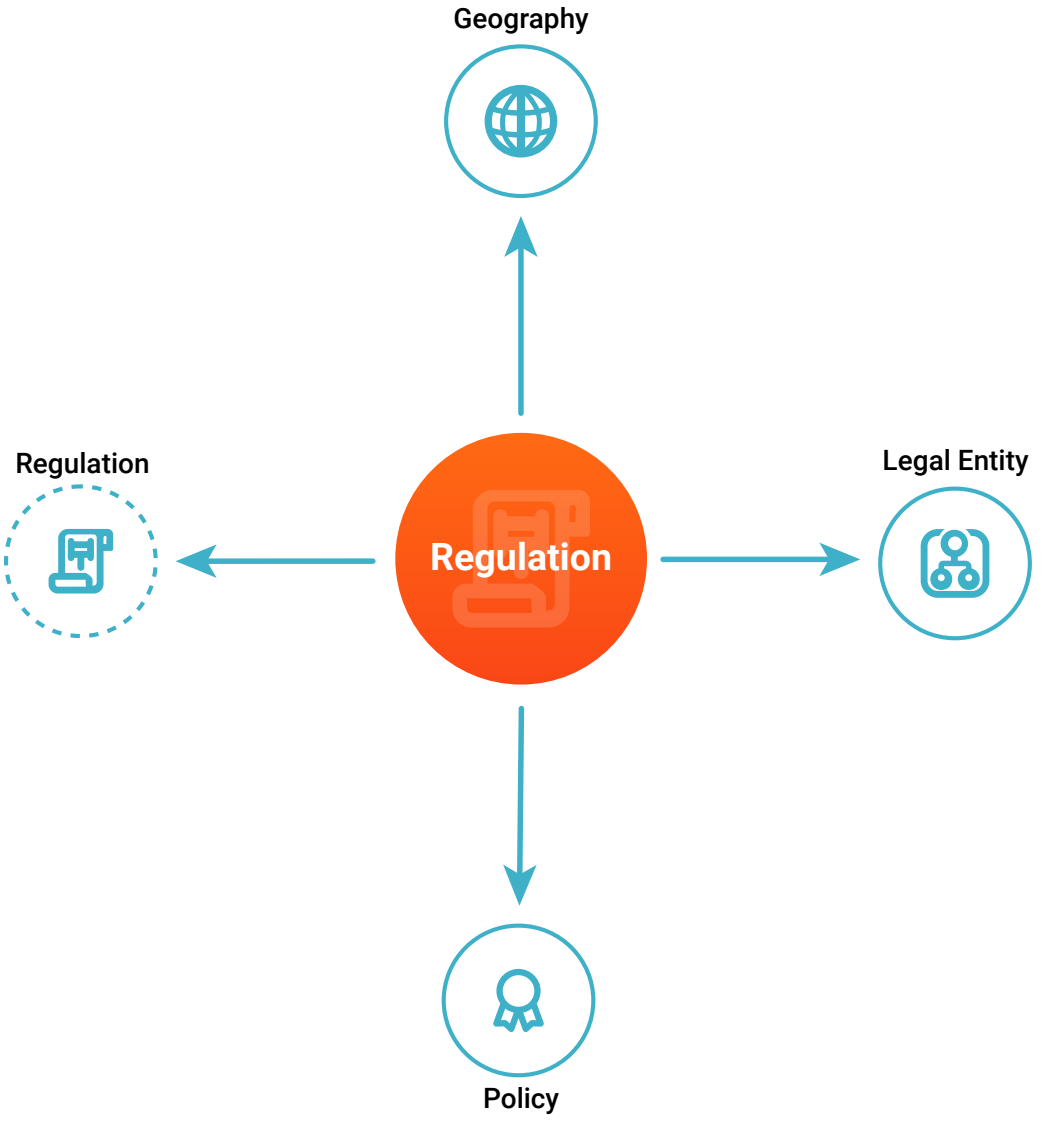
A Project asset represents a collection of activities that are planned and organized to achieve a particular set of objectives.

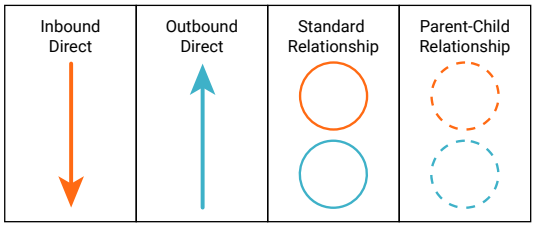




Regulation

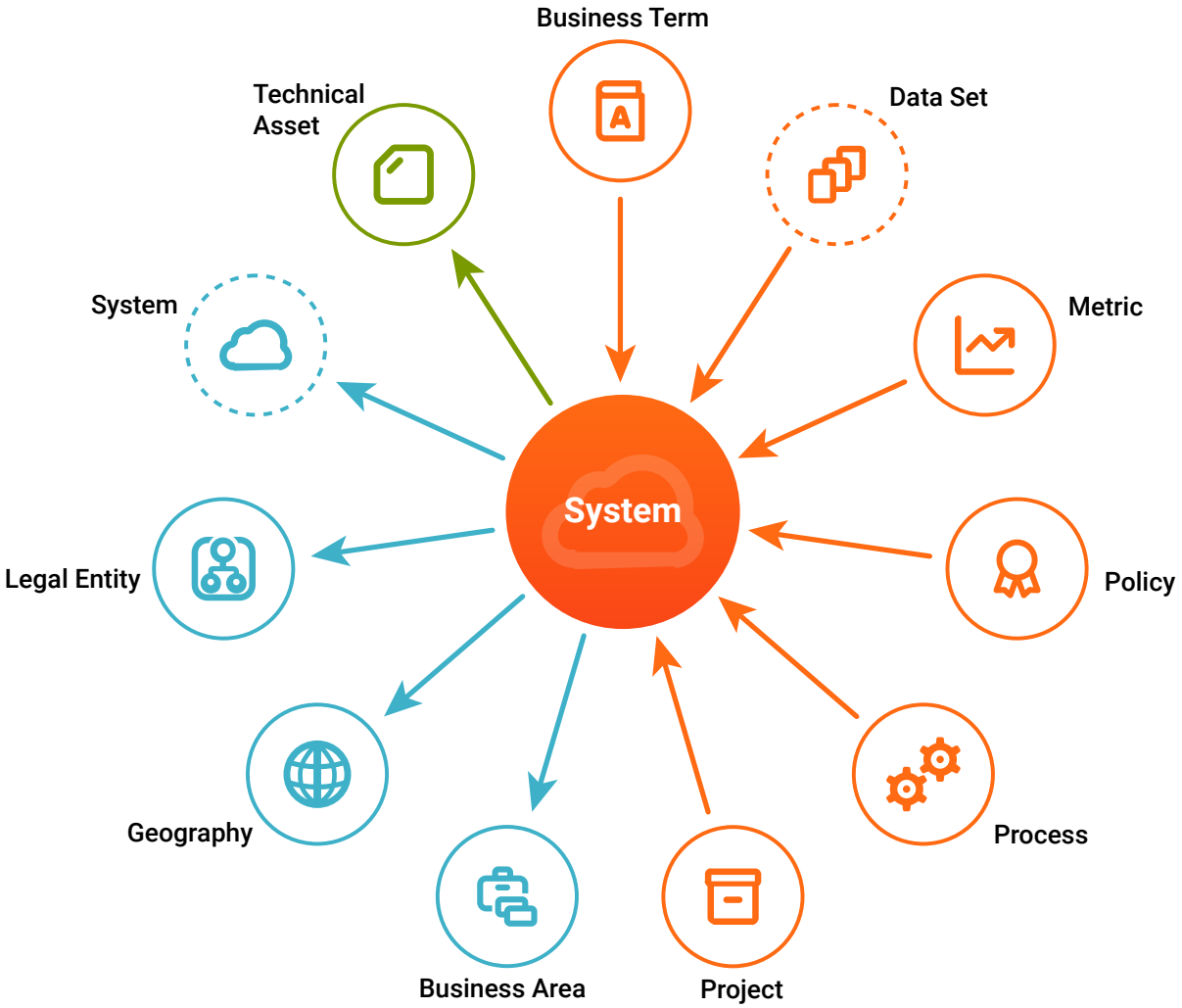
A Regulation asset type allows you to document the important clauses of a major legislation. A legislation is a key driver of internal policies that direct how an organization conducts its business.

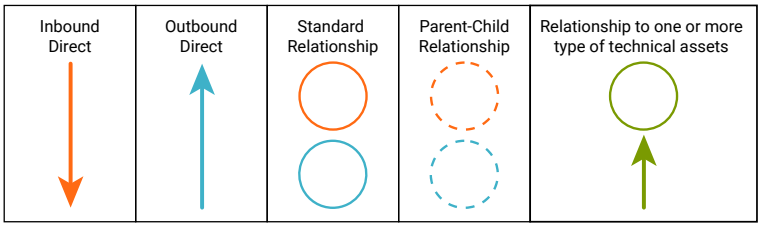




System

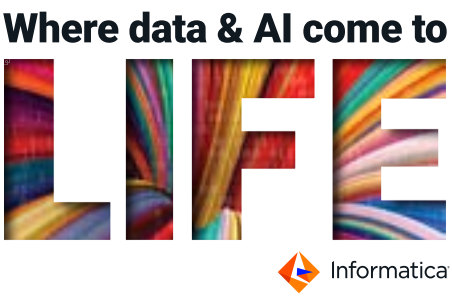
A System asset represents a recognizable location or application that typically contains multiple data sets. In a System asset, the system name is often more business-friendly than the technical names used for technical assets. The system name allows the business users that create and manage the data to easily identify the asset.





About Us

Informatica (NYSE: INFA) brings data and AI to life by empowering businesses to realize the transformative power of their most critical assets. When properly unlocked, data becomes a living and trusted resource that is democratized across your organization, turning chaos into clarity. Through the Informatica Intelligent Data Management Cloud™, companies are breathing life into their data to drive bigger ideas, create improved processes, and reduce costs. Powered by CLAIRE®, our AI engine, it's the only cloud dedicated to managing data of any type, pattern, complexity, or workload across any location — all on a single platform.



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